

NATASHA YOTMANEE

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in International Relations; Minor in Data Science

Expected May 2026

William & Mary — Williamsburg, VA

Senior Capstone Research: *"Why States Hedge Differently: Systemic Pressures & Domestic Constraints in Southeast Asia."*

Exchange Semester

February - June 2025

Tsinghua University (清华大学) — Beijing, China

Summer Language Program

June - August 2025

Beijing Language and Culture University (北京语言大学) — Beijing, China

PROFESSIONAL & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

February 2026 - Present

Department of Government, William & Mary

Project: Politics of Recognition and the Case of One China.

- Support data modeling and conduct analysis on an original cross-national dataset of diplomatic recognition patterns (1945–1991), examining conditions under which newly decolonized states recognized the PRC versus the ROC.
- Clean, prepare, and document large structured datasets to support comparative political analysis and ensure reproducibility across research stages.
- Synthesize academic literature on state recognition and institutional decision-making to inform ongoing faculty research.

Team Leader

August 2025 - January 2026

Asia Policy Lab, William & Mary

Project: Storied States

- Selected as 1 of 13 undergraduates for a competitive faculty-led research program; appointed Team Leader for the Storied States project.
- Designed and led a three-member team in applying a structured coding protocol for ~500 political speeches from Taiwan and South Korea, managing task allocation, timelines, and quality control.
- Cleaned and standardized a 260-document subset of Taiwanese political speeches, producing a coded dataset delivered to faculty for quantitative modeling.
- Conducted sentence-level coding of elite political discourse across Taiwan's democratization periods alongside the team, ensuring consistency and analytical rigor.

Communications Fellow

May 2024 - August 2024

Risk Anticipation Hub (RAH), Crisis Bureau - United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

- Supported internal communications for the RAH, a team focused on foresight and crisis analysis within UNDP's Crisis Bureau.
- Produced written event coverage and recaps for UNDP newsletters and internal platforms, summarizing RAH team activities and engagements for internal audiences.
- Developed standardized briefing and presentation templates to improve consistency in messaging and branding across RAH products.

Ukraine War Study Intern

January 2023 - April 2024

Strategic Studies Institute, US Army War College (USAWC)

- Conducted literature reviews and primary source research supporting an unclassified monograph on the war in Ukraine, contributing to analysis of security cooperation dynamics.
- Authored an independent research study on the Russo-Georgian War (2008–2014) examining security cooperation lessons for U.S. policy; findings contributed to a forthcoming monograph.
- Presented research findings and policy recommendations to briefing teams supporting senior military and civilian officials.

Young Professionals Program Participant

June 2023 - August 2023

East-West Center (EWC) in Washington

- Researched U.S.-ASEAN relations and co-edited the ASEAN Matters for America publication (6th ed.), a widely distributed policy resource for U.S. policymakers and stakeholders.
- Authored and co-authored three articles for the Asia Matters for America platform reporting on U.S.-Asia community relations, cultural events, and diaspora news.
- Produced internal analytical reports on Indo-Pacific events and U.S. strategic priorities; supported EWC event coordination.

The Thai American National Internship Program (TANIP) Participant

June 2023 - August 2023

The Royal Thai Embassy & US-Asia Institute

- Selected as 1 of 5 participants for the Thai American National Internship Program (TANIP).
- Researched and authored a cybersecurity policy memo addressing the rise of cybercrime in Thailand, with recommendations for bilateral U.S.-Thai policy coordination.
- Supported media outreach for the Sawasdee DC festival, producing 10+ marketing videos and coordinating with 30+ media outlets and content creators.

PUBLICATIONS

- Yotmanee, N. "[Japan, & Taiwan Donate to Maui](#)," *Asia Matters for America*, 2023.
- Yotmanee, N. "[Eden Center Redevelopment Plan Approved](#)," *Asia Matters for America*, 2023.
- Maga, J., and Yotmanee, N. "[Sawasdee Festival: Celebrating the 190th Anniversary of US-Thai Relations](#)," *Asia Matters for America*, 2023.

RESEARCH CONTRIBUTIONS

ASEAN Matters for America / America Matters for ASEAN, 6th ed. East-West Center, 2023.

- Research and content contributor; co-editor of the publication.

“Crisis in the Caucasus: Invasion of Georgia, 2008–2014.” Strategic Studies Institute, USAWC, 2024.

- Internal research study contributing to a forthcoming monograph tentatively titled "Building Partner Capacity in Ukraine."

AWARDS & PROGRAMS

Robert M. & Rebecca W. Gates Scholarship

February - June 2025

Reves Center for International Studies, William & Mary

- Merit-based scholarship awarded to outstanding students in International Relations, Global Studies, or Africana Studies; \$7,500 awarded for study abroad.

Global Scholars Program Participant

August 2023 - 2024

Global Research Institute, William & Mary

- Selected as 1 of 18 students for a competitive, year-long global policy and research cohort.

SKILLS

Software: Python (intermediate), SQL (basic), R (basic).

Languages: English (native), Thai (oral proficiency), Mandarin Chinese (intermediate).

REFERENCES

Dr. Eun A Jo

Assistant Professor of Government at William & Mary (W&M)

Director of W&M's Asia Policy Lab

ejo@wm.edu

Dr. Michael E. Lynch

Associate Professor at U.S. Army War College (USAWC)

Research Professor of North American National Security Affairs at USAWC's Strategic Studies Institute

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Dr. Michael Tierney

George & Mary Hylton Professor of International Relations at William & Mary (W&M)

Director of W&M's Global Research Institute

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